fig about this advice. The terrorists were emboldened and energised by the lackadaisical approach of the government.

They did not bother to be faceless any more. Their spokespersons addressed the media and claimed responsibilities of militant and terrorist acts. However, the government hesitated to name them and tackle them. Ironically, on the other hand, people reacted in unison against the US drone campaign, which was many decibels higher than that against the terrorist attacks by TTP.

TTP threatened to avenge the death of Waliur Rehman. This reaction was obviously on the cards. What else could one expect from a terrorist group whose stalwart had been killed? But it could be a blessing in disguise. The newly elected parties who were to form governments in the Centre and in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa were stirred to come out of the fanciful world of achieving peace by negotiating with the terrorists. TTP in any case ignored its offer to hold talks for peace, making it easier for the governments to take the other way. America haters were feverishly propelling the conspiracy theory that a US drone killed Waliur Rehman to derail the chances of negotiations with TTP. They argued that Waliur Rehman was pro-negotiations. His death had undermined the chances of talks with TTP. Waliur Rehman's position and record belied the tiniest chance of this noble gesture from him. He carried a bounty of Rs 50 million on his head announced by the government of Pakistan and also a $5 million reward from the US, which had listed him as a 'specially designated global terrorist'. He was closely associated with the Haqqani network that operated in Afghanistan. It had been a source of rift between Pakistan and the US in 2011, due to its devastating attacks on the US and NATO forces.

His death created further schisms in an already splintered TTP as there were unconfirmed reports of suspicion on Hakimullah Mehsud's men to have leaked intelligence to facilitate the attack on Waliur Rehman. Some quarters were of the view that Hakimullah Mehsud was not pleased with his proximity with the Haqqani group, which gave him greater influence on Afghan Taliban and granted him more respect in all the groups (*The News International*, 2013).

In 2013, the death of Hakimullah Mehsud was again viewed as a threat to the control and command of TTP. Rather they not only overcame the empty space created by Hakimullah's death but also chose an equally fierce *Amir*, namely Maulvi Fazlullah from Swat. It was a